

COMBAT MINDSET — THE WAY FORWARD

Joint NZALC and Human Performance Cell response to COMDT ACS

WARFIGHTING IMPERATIVE

REMAIN EFFECTIVE. **ACT DECISIVELY.**

Army requires individuals, teams and leaders who remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat.



COMBAT MINDSET

Combat-specific expression

▼ enabled by



PERFORMANCE UNDER PRESSURE

Enabling human-performance capability

▼ developed and organised through



ARMY COMBAT MINDSET FRAMEWORK

Organising model

▼ delivered through

Combat Mindset is the combat-specific expression of Performance Under Pressure.

The individual and collective readiness and disposition to remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat in order to achieve the mission.

Performance Under Pressure is the trainable individual and collective human-performance capability to:

- ✓ Prepare for pressure
- ✓ Adapt within pressure
- ✓ Maintain performance through pressure
- ✓ Recover from pressure

Applicable across combat, command, crisis response, training, garrison leadership and high-risk technical activity.

The Army Combat Mindset Framework is the organising model through which Army defines, develops, integrates and assures the capabilities, products and governance arrangements that enable Combat Mindset.

It organises:

- Doctrinal definitions
- Developmental progression
- Governance
- Desired outcomes
- Products and methods
- Evidence
- Capability strands
- Delivery responsibilities
- Assurance

CAPABILITY STRANDS



Leadership



Mental skills



Performance cognition



Resilience & recovery



Physical performance



Professional identity & values



Individual & collective exposure to pressure

▼ each product contributes across multiple strands

TRAINING PRODUCTS AND METHODS

NZALC Performance Under Pressure package

NZDF Psychology products

COGCON MVP
(Performance cognition)
Developmental MVP

Scenario & experiential training

Physical conditioning

Structured reflection & recovery

Other products identified in Phase 1 mapping

Delivered across the Prepare – Perform – Recover cycle and the Lead Self → Lead Teams → Lead Leaders → Lead Systems progression



GOVERNANCE AND ASSURANCE

- Army Sponsor — strategic sponsorship and policy direction
- COMDT ACS — interim capability integrator
- ACS — framework development and delivery coordination
- HPC — COGCON product steward; performance-cognition adviser
- Layered doctrine, evidence, professional and delivery assurance



HARDER TO KILL

Proposed Warfighter Focus line — subject to sponsor endorsement



PROGRAMME OF WORK — PHASES 0–5

0. Define terms, sponsorship and relationship
1. Map current capabilities and products
2. Draft the Army Combat Mindset Framework
3. Validate with stakeholders and force employers
4. Limited COGCON MVP integration trial (subject to capacity)
5. Report back — Framework v1.0, November 2026

KEY POINT Performance Under Pressure is developed across relevant settings. When expressed in combat and aligned with purpose, identity, values, leadership and the willingness to act, it contributes to Combat Mindset.